

CELESTIAL BODIES OF OUR SOLAR SYSTEM



Rocky body smaller than a planet that orbits the sun

ASTEROID

Largest Asteroids in our solar system

1 Ceres

Discovered in 1801 by Giuseppe Piazzi, Ceres is the largest asteroid and only dwarf planet in the asteroid belt, possibly containing more water than Earth's freshwater. It orbits the Sun in 4.6 years and represents a third of the asteroid belt's mass.

4 Vesta

Discovered in 1807, 4 Vesta is the second-largest asteroid, contributing to 9% of the asteroid belt's mass and has a significant crater from a past collision. Some fragments from Vesta are believed to be the source of HED meteorites found on Earth.

2 Pallas

Discovered in 1802, 2 Pallas is roughly similar in size to Vesta but holds just 7% of the asteroid belt's mass. Its orbit, ranging from 2.132 to 3.412 AU, is notably inclined by 35° to the main asteroid belt's plane.

10 Hygiea

Discovered in 1849, 10 Hygiea is the fourth-largest asteroid with an average size of 431 km, orbiting the Sun every 5.56 years between 2.77 and 3.507 AU. It dominates the Hygiea family, constituting over 90% of its mass.

704 Interamnia

704 Interamnia, averaging 326 km in diameter, constitutes about 1.2% of the asteroid belt's mass. It orbits the Sun in 5.36 years between 2.601 and 3.522 AU.

METEORITE

Classification & Top 10 Meteorites Found

